

Working in a shop

Unit 1 How to use a till



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Introduction

This resource has been produced in two different formats:

- a self-access resource for learners with online activities
- this teacher's pack, including teachers' notes and worksheets to download

Overview

'Working in a Shop' is aimed primarily at learners who are already working in retail or who want to find out more about working in the sector, but will appeal to any learners who need to talk about processes, prices or career development. The resource uses authentic sound recordings as a springboard for practice in listening, speaking, writing and numeracy skills within this context.

The materials are designed to be flexible in terms of differentiation, and are accessible to established E2 (Access 2) learners and at the same time relevant to L1 (Intermediate 1) learners.

Level: ESOL Entry 3 / SQA ESOL Intermediate 1 in Scotland / A2 – B2 CEFR Framework

Structure, learning hours and delivery context

The resource provides a minimum of six hours of learning in a classroom or workplace context through a series of three linked units. Each unit can be taught as a standalone. The resource is flexible in terms of timing and differentiation. Here is an overview of the content of each unit:

- Unit 1: How to use a till

Skills: Listening to instructions on how to use a till; writing notes

Language focus: Key vocabulary; conditionals; prepositions and phrasal verbs

- Unit 2: I can't see a price

Skills: Listening to a simple interaction with a customer; listening to prices

Language focus: Using definite and indefinite articles; aural discrimination of numbers such as 15 and 50; different ways of saying prices

- Unit 3: Developing your career

Skills: Listening to advice on career development; asking for advice on career development

Language focus: Key vocabulary; word stress; cleft sentences to highlight information; zero infinitive/ 'to' infinitive/ '-ing' form

The recordings in this resource were made 'in situ' to try to ensure the language was as authentic as possible. They may therefore be of a slightly 'grainy' quality. They were made by ESOL specialist without any technical support using small fairly inexpensive equipment. We hope this may encourage other ESOL teachers to use this model and to focus on the authentic language used in particular contexts

Unit 1 How to use a till - teacher's notes

Time: Approximately 2 hours. Timings are flexible and teachers can break down the units into smaller chunks of learning and build in revision as required.

Aims

- To establish the context for learning.
- To stimulate discussion about working in retail.
- To pre-teach key vocabulary.
- To help learners understand instructions on how to use a till.
- To encourage learners to use conditional sentences without worrying about 'rules'.
- To encourage learners to use prepositions in 'chunks' without worrying about 'rules'.
- To enable learners to write simple instructions.
- To enable learners to give instructions on using other types of simple equipment.

Objectives

All learners will be able to:

- Read, pronounce and hear key vocabulary.
- Follow instructions about how to use a till.
- Write simple notes to colleagues.

Some learners will be able to:

- Talk about their own experience in retail.
- Give instructions on using other types of simple equipment.

Preparation

You will need:

- A data projector to show images in task 4. A PowerPoint for can be found on ESOLNexus website
- computers for each learner/pair of learners, with earphones or audio speakers.
- The online activities can be found at: **How to use a till (1)** <http://esol.britishcouncil.org/retail/how-use-till-1> and **How to use a till (2)** <http://esol.britishcouncil.org/retail/how-use-till-2>

If computers are not available, you will need:

- audio equipment and to download sound file - STE-039 edit.mp3
- one copy of the learner resources for each learners (pages 9 – 17)
- Answers
- Transcript
- dictionaries
- thesauri

Suggested Procedure

Lead-in

Set the context by asking if any of your learners work in a shop or know someone who does. Then discuss the different job roles that this involves; focus the discussion on 'till skills' and tell them that in this unit they will hear Rob explaining the basics and learn some useful language. Point out that Unit 2 will focus on customer service. Suggested questions:

Do you enjoy working in a shop?

Do you know how to use a till?

Do you need to explain to other people how to use a till?

Activity 1: Vocabulary matching

If they have access to computers, learners can go to the online activities in **How to use a till (1)** and follow the instructions online. Alternatively hand out the paper version.

This worksheet pre-teaches vocabulary which comes up repeatedly in the recording and in the follow-up activities. It can be done in pairs or groups. Alternatively you can cut up the matching task and use it for a mingle activity.

Once the task is finished the pronunciation should be drilled thoroughly. Try drilling the words in context rather than in isolation; you will find examples in the transcript.

Activity 2: True or false?

If they have access to computers, learners can go to the online activities in **How to use a till (1)** and follow the instructions online. Alternatively hand out the paper version. Use recording 'How to use a till.'

Before listening, try to elicit from the learners what they know about using a till. If they have experience of using a till, they may be able to answer the questions before listening; in this case they will listen to confirm their answers.

Activity 3: Sequencing

If they have access to computers, learners can go to the online activities in **How to use a till (1)** and follow the instructions online. Alternatively hand out the paper version

Having heard the recording once already, the learners may be able to complete this activity before listening again to confirm their answers. They can work alone or in pairs and number the stages 1 - 7 or you can cut the stages up for groups to put into sequence.

Activity 4: Picture matching

If they have access to computers, learners can go to the online activities in **How to use a till (1)** and follow the instructions online. Alternatively hand out the paper version for pair work, or use the PowerPoint slides and do it as a whole-class activity.

The learners should be able to complete this activity from memory.

Activity 5: Conditionals matching

If they have access to computers, learners can go to the online activities in **How to use a till (2)** and follow the instructions online. Alternatively hand out the paper version.

As the focus is now on a grammar point, the learners may need to listen again to confirm their answers after completing the matching exercise. They can work alone or in pairs, or you can cut the clauses up for groups to match.

Note that the sentences reflect the spontaneous use of conditionals by a native speaker, and do not follow the 'textbook rules' of 'First Conditional', 'Second Conditional', etc. If learners ask about rules, the best approach is to say that Present Simple in the 'if' clause or main clause suggests greater likelihood, while Past Simple in the 'if' clause or 'would' in the main clause suggests less likelihood, but there is a great deal of overlap. A look at the answers to the activity will show that all possible permutations occur with no real difference in meaning:

If the price was £2.50	you always put it in pence.
If it's menswear	you would select 'mens'.
Let's say this is a music item,	we would select 'music'.
If there's another item	then you would just add in the price for the next item and the category after that.
If they're paying by cash	you put in the amount they give you in cash.
So if they give you £10	you would put in 'ten zero zero'.

In view of this, the focus of the activity should be on encouraging learners to use a range of forms when using conditionals, rather than on traditional notions of 'accuracy'. Also point out that 'let's say' is a very common alternative to 'if'.

Activity 6: Gap fill

If they have access to computers, learners can go to the online activities in **How to use a till (2)** and follow the instructions online. Alternatively hand out the paper version.

The learners should be able to complete this activity from memory. There is one missing word for each gap.

Each question shows part of Rob's talk about how to use the till. If learners want to do the exercise while listening to the recording, or if you want them to listen to confirm their answers, the start times for each excerpt are as follows:

Question 1; 0 seconds

Question 2; 16 seconds

Question 3; 36 seconds

Question 4; 1 minute 21 seconds

The focus here is on phrases containing prepositions; 'on the screen', 'in pence', 'the price for', 'the amount of X', 'out of (the till)', 'and so on', 'as many as', 'due to (receive)' and on the phrasal verbs 'put in', 'come up', 'add in', 'put through'. As these are collocations, learners should be encouraged to learn them as 'chunks' rather than worry about learning 'rules for using prepositions'. To help with this, it is a good idea to drill these chunks thoroughly after finishing the activity. Also concept check that in this instance, 'due to' has a similar meaning to 'should'.

Activity 7: Writing

If they have access to computers, learners can go to the online activities in **How to use a till (2)** and follow the instructions online. Alternatively hand out the paper version.

Set the context;

'Your colleague Dave always forgets how to use the till! You need to write some notes to stick on the till to remind him. See how quickly you can do this so that you don't keep your customers waiting!'

More confident learners should be able to write post-it notes with the following prompts:

Note 1: When a customer wants to pay £5, Dave enters 5p.

Note 2: When a customer wants to buy more than one item, he presses 'subtotal' too soon.

Note 3: He tries to put credit cards in the till.

Otherwise, cut up the chunks for learners to put together in groups.

Follow-up activities

After the learners have done the listening exercises you can download the transcript and ask them to check any unfamiliar words in their dictionaries. They may also want to listen again while reading the transcript to focus on the pronunciation of any tricky words or chunks.

Then elicit any other processes that need to be learned in a retail or other context; more confident learners should be able to use the language in the recording as a model for describing how to use other equipment such as a photocopier (or items in the classroom such as a CD player).

The other two units in the retail series – 'I can't see a price' and 'Career development' – will also provide learners with further practice in this context.

It might be interesting to share your experience of using these materials and hear how other teachers got on. What problems did you encounter and what was successful? Why not post a comment on the Nexus website?



Unit 1 How to use a till learner resources

Activity 1: Vocabulary matching

thing	how much
men's clothes	the money you give back to the customer
cups, plates, towels, etc.	the things that someone buys
choose	type or group

CHANGE	
SELECT	
CATEGORY	
MENSWEAR	
HOMEWARE	
ITEM	
PURCHASE S(noun)	
AMOUNT	

Activity 2: True or false?

Read the statements and then listen to Rob talking about how to use a till. Decide if the statements are true or false.

Question 1

When you put in the price of an item, you always put it in pounds.

Question 2

If you add another item, you don't need to put in the category.

Question 3

If the customer is paying by credit card, you have to use the card machine.

Question 4

The till tells you how much change to give.

Activity 3: Sequencing

Listen to Rob talking about how to use a till and put the sentences in the right order.

Give the customer their change.

Select the category.

If there's another item, add the price and category.

Press 'subtotal'.

Put the price in.

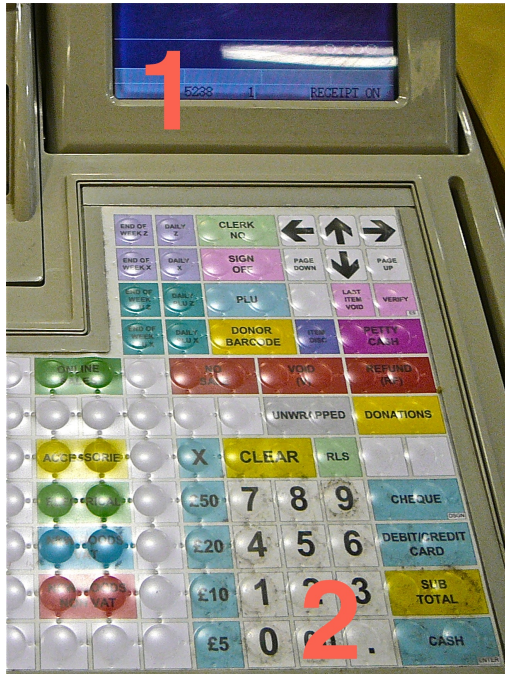
Ask the customer how they'd like to pay.

If they are paying by cash, put in the amount they give you and press 'cash'.

Activity 4: Vocabulary matching

Look at the red numbers on the pictures and choose the words that go with the number. The words are from the recording of Rob.

Question 1



THE PRICE COMES UP

1. _____

PUT THE PRICE IN

2. _____

Question 2



PUT THE PRICE IN

1. _____

SELECT THE CATEGORY

2. _____

HOW TO PAY

3. _____

Activity 5: Conditionals matching

Make complete sentences by putting the endings of the sentences in the top boxes with the beginnings at the bottom.

we would select 'music'.	then you would just add in the price for the next item and the category after that.
you always put it in pence.	you would put in 'ten zero zero'.
you would select 'mens'.	you put in the amount they give you in cash.

If the price was £2.50	
If it's menswear	
Let's say this is a music item,	
If there's another item	
If they're paying by cash	
So if they give you £10	

Activity 6: Gap fill

Each question shows part of Rob's talk about how to use the till. Write in the missing words. There is one missing word for each gap.

Question 1

OK, so the main thing, the first thing to know, is where to put the price _____. So you put the price _____ using these numbers here, so if the price was £2.50, you always put it _____ pence.

Question 2

And you can see here _____ the screen that the price comes _____.

Question 3

And if there's another item, then you would just add _____ the price _____ the next item and the category after that, and so _____ for as many items _____ the person is buying. At the end, when you want to put _____ the payment, after everything's been added, you would press 'subtotal'. That will give you the total price _____ this purchase.

Question 4

Enter the amount _____ cash they give you and press 'cash'. It will tell you how much change they are due _____ receive, and you would give them the change _____ of the till. That's the main thing to know when putting _____ sales.

Activity 7: Writing

You need to write some notes to stick on the till to remind Dave, your colleague, how to use the till. He always forgets how to use the till. Put boxes in the correct order to write your notes.

Note 1

So remember

the price

Always

500 pence!

in pence.

5 pounds is

put in

Activity 7: Writing**Note 2**

all

'subtotal'

until

press

put in

Don't

you've

the items!

Activity 7: Writing**Note 3**

credit cards

put

You

card machine!

in the

have to

Unit 1 Using a till answers

Activity 1: Vocabulary matching

SELECT	choose
CATEGORY	type or group
MENSWEAR	men's clothes
HOMEWARE	cups, plates, towels, etc.
ITEM	thing
PURCHASE (noun)	the things that someone buys
AMOUNT	how much
CHANGE	the money you give back to the customer

Activity 2: True or false?

Question 1: False

Question 2: False

Question 3: True

Question 4: True

Activity 3: Sequencing

Put the price in.

Select the category.

If there's another item, add the price and category.

Press 'subtotal'.

Ask the customer how they'd like to pay.

If they are paying by cash, put in the amount they give you and press 'cash'.

Give the customer their change.

Activity 4: Vocabulary matching**Question 1**

1. THE PRICE COMES UP
2. PUT THE PRICE IN

Question 2

1. SELECT THE CATEGORY
2. PUT THE PRICE IN
3. HOW TO PAY

Activity 5: Conditionals matching

If the price was £2.50	you always put it in pence.
If it's menswear	you would select 'mens'.
Let's say this is a music item,	we would select 'music'.
If there's another item	then you would just add in the price for the next item and the category after that.
If they're paying by cash	you put in the amount they give you in cash.
So if they give you £10	you would put in 'ten zero zero'.

Activity 6: Gap fill

1. (0 seconds) OK, so the main thing, the first thing to know is, where to put the price in. So you put the price in using these numbers here, so if the price was £2.50, you always put it in pence.
2. (16 seconds) And you can see here on the screen that the price comes up.
3. (36 seconds) And if there's another item, then you would just add in the price for the next item and the category after that, and so on for as many items as the person is buying. At the end, when you want to put through the payment, after everything's been added, you would press 'subtotal'. That will give you the total price for this purchase.
4. (1:21 seconds) Enter the amount of cash they give you and press 'cash'. It will tell you how much change they are due to receive, and you would give them the change out of the till. That's the main thing to know when putting through sales.

Activity 7: Writing**Note 1**

Always put in the price in pence. So remember 5 pounds is 500 pence!

Note 2

Don't press 'subtotal' until you've put in all the items!

Note 3

You have to put credit cards in the card machine!

Unit 1 How to use a till transcript

00:00

OK, so the main thing, the first thing to know, is where to put the price in. So you put the price in using these numbers here, so if the price was two fifty, you always put it in pence, so you'll put two, two pound fifty, you put 'two five zero'. And you can see here on the screen that the price comes up. After you've put in the price, you would select the category that the item is, so if it's a book you would select 'books'; if it's menswear you would select 'mens'; homeware, 'homeware', et cetera. So, let's say this is a music item, we would select 'music'.

00:36

And if there's another item, then you would just add in the price for the next item and the category after that, and so on for as many items as the person is buying. At the end, when you want to put through the payment, after everything's been added, you would press 'subtotal'. That will give you the total price for this purchase. Then you will ask the customer how they would like to pay. If they're paying by cash, you put in the amount they give you in cash. So if they give you ten pounds, you would put in 'ten zero zero', and then you would press 'cash'.

01:09

If they're paying by credit card you would just pay, or debit card, you would just pay, press the 'debit/credit card' button, and then you would use the card machine separately.

01:18

Mm, after you press 'cash', they enter the amount of cash they give you and press 'cash'. It will tell you how much change they are due to receive, and you would give them the change out of the till. That's the main thing to know when putting through sales.

> 01:34